



NATIONAL COUNCIL FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP (NCIE) INDIA

Institutional Collaboration & Strategic Partnership

Multi-Stakeholder Engagement Models & MoU Guidelines

Formal framework governing 12 partnership categories across universities, industry, accelerators, CSR trusts, and public agencies; includes 7 collaboration models, due diligence protocols, and MoU guidelines.

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA MINISTERIAL COORDINATION & ALIGNMENT

MSDE

Skill Development &
Entrepreneurship

MSME

Micro, Small &
Medium Enterprises

MeitY

Electronics &
Information Technology

MCA

Ministry of
Corporate Affairs

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SUPPORTING NATIONAL INITIATIVES & STRATEGIC ALLIANCES



NCIE COLLABORATION & PARTNERSHIP FRAMEWORK

National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)

Policy Area: Collaboration, Partnerships & Institutional Engagement

Applicable To: Government & Public Institutions, Educational Institutions, Industry, CSR Organisations, Incubators, Accelerators, Investors, NGOs, Knowledge Partners and Other Eligible Organisations

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1. INTRODUCTION

The **NCIE Collaboration & Partnership Framework** establishes a structured approach for developing and managing collaborations with organisations that can contribute to **innovation, entrepreneurship, technology, skill development, youth development, institutional strengthening, research, incubation and startup ecosystem development.**

The framework is intended to create meaningful institutional relationships through which participating organisations can contribute their respective **expertise, infrastructure, knowledge, networks, resources and programme capabilities.**

NCIE may enter into appropriate collaboration arrangements based on the nature, scope, objectives and requirements of each proposed partnership.

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2. VISION

To establish a collaborative ecosystem connecting institutions, Government and public-sector stakeholders, academia, industry, CSR organisations, innovation ecosystems and knowledge partners to strengthen innovation and entrepreneurship opportunities for students, youth, innovators and institutions.

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3. COLLABORATION OBJECTIVES

The framework aims to:

- Develop strategic institutional partnerships.
- Promote innovation and entrepreneurship.
- Strengthen industry–academia engagement.
- Facilitate student and youth development.
- Support institutional innovation ecosystems.
- Facilitate technology and knowledge exchange.
- Encourage research and project collaboration.
- Develop mentorship and expert networks.
- Facilitate incubation and startup ecosystem connectivity.
- Explore appropriate CSR and development partnerships.
- Facilitate suitable Government and public-sector engagement.
- Create opportunities for innovation, skills and entrepreneurship programmes.

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4. PARTNERSHIP PRINCIPLES

NCIE collaborations shall be guided by the following principles:

Mutual Value

Partnerships should provide meaningful value to participating organisations and beneficiaries.

Transparency

Roles, responsibilities and deliverables should be clearly documented.

Accountability

Each party should remain responsible for its agreed commitments.

Compliance

Activities shall be undertaken in accordance with applicable laws, regulations, institutional policies and agreements.

Non-Exclusivity

Unless specifically agreed otherwise, collaboration should not automatically create exclusivity.

Quality

Programmes and activities should maintain appropriate quality standards.

Impact

Partnerships should seek measurable educational, innovation, entrepreneurial or social outcomes.

Sustainability

Collaborations should be designed for practical and sustainable implementation.

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5. PARTNERSHIP CATEGORIES

NCIE may develop partnerships across the following categories:

1. Government & Public-Sector Partnerships
2. Academic & Institutional Partnerships
3. Industry Partnerships
4. CSR Partnerships
5. Incubator & Accelerator Partnerships
6. Startup Ecosystem Partnerships
7. Investor Ecosystem Partnerships
8. Research & Knowledge Partnerships
9. NGO & Community Partnerships
10. Technology & Digital Partnerships
11. Media & Outreach Partnerships
12. International / Global Knowledge Partnerships, where appropriate

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6. GOVERNMENT & PUBLIC-SECTOR COLLABORATION

NCIE may engage with eligible Government Ministries, Departments,

public institutions and other public-sector stakeholders for appropriate programmes.

Potential areas include:

- Innovation programmes
- Skill development
- Youth development
- Entrepreneurship
- Institutional capacity building
- Technology awareness
- Research and knowledge initiatives
- Programme implementation
- Public awareness
- Community development

Such collaboration shall be based on appropriate **official communication, approval, agreement, MoU, sanction or other applicable documentation**, wherever required.

Important

A collaboration proposal, meeting, correspondence or MoU shall not by itself be represented as Government endorsement, Government ownership, statutory authority or Government funding unless such status is expressly established through appropriate official documentation.

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7. MINISTRY & DEPARTMENT ENGAGEMENT

Where relevant to programme objectives, NCIE may approach appropriate Ministries and Departments for:

- Programme collaboration
- Technical guidance
- Institutional engagement
- Scheme convergence
- Capacity-building initiatives
- Innovation and entrepreneurship programmes
- Youth development programmes
- Skill initiatives

Any Government funding or programme support shall remain subject to the **concerned Ministry/Department's eligibility requirements, proposal evaluation, approval process, applicable guidelines and availability of funds.**

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8. ACADEMIC & INSTITUTIONAL PARTNERSHIPS

NCIE may collaborate with:

- Universities
- Colleges
- Engineering institutions
- Technical institutions
- Professional institutions
- Schools
- Research institutions
- Training institutions
- Innovation centres

Potential activities include:

- Student innovation programmes
 - Entrepreneurship programmes
 - Leadership development
 - AI and digital skills
 - Workshops
 - Seminars
 - Hackathons
 - Internships
 - Mentorship
 - Faculty development
 - Startup programmes
 - Innovation challenges
 - Institutional capacity building
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9. INSTITUTIONAL ONBOARDING

Eligible institutions may be onboarded through a structured process:

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST



INSTITUTIONAL DISCUSSION



REQUIREMENT / NEED ASSESSMENT



PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL



DUE DILIGENCE



ROLE & RESPONSIBILITY DEFINITION



APPROVAL



MoU / AGREEMENT, WHERE REQUIRED



PROGRAMME IMPLEMENTATION



MONITORING & REVIEW



10. INDUSTRY PARTNERSHIPS

NCIE may engage with companies and industry organisations to facilitate:

- Industry exposure
- Expert sessions

- Mentorship
- Technology awareness
- Industry projects
- Skill development
- Internships
- Entrepreneurship programmes
- Innovation challenges
- Industry–academia collaboration
- Startup ecosystem engagement

Industry partners may contribute through expertise, technology, mentorship, infrastructure, programme support or other mutually agreed mechanisms.

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11. CSR PARTNERSHIP FRAMEWORK

NCIE may engage eligible corporate organisations for CSR-supported programmes in accordance with applicable CSR requirements and the organisation's CSR policy.

Potential areas include:

- Education
- Skill development
- Innovation
- Entrepreneurship
- Digital capability
- Youth development
- Institutional development
- Innovation infrastructure
- Social-impact initiatives

CSR support shall be subject to:

CSR ELIGIBILITY → PROJECT PROPOSAL → DUE DILIGENCE → CORPORATE REVIEW → APPROVAL → AGREEMENT → IMPLEMENTATION → REPORTING

CSR support shall not be represented as guaranteed unless formally approved and documented by the concerned CSR organisation.

12. INCUBATOR & ACCELERATOR PARTNERSHIPS

NCIE may develop partnerships with eligible:

- Incubators
- Accelerators
- Innovation centres
- Startup support organisations
- Entrepreneurship development centres

Potential areas include:

- Startup referrals
- Mentorship
- Incubation
- Acceleration
- Prototype development
- Business development
- Investor readiness
- Demo days
- Startup showcases

Admission into any external incubator or accelerator shall remain subject to that organisation's independent eligibility and selection process.

13. STARTUP ECOSYSTEM PARTNERSHIPS

NCIE may collaborate with startup ecosystem organisations to support:

- Startup awareness
- Entrepreneurship education
- Idea validation
- Prototype development
- Mentorship
- Incubation
- Market access
- Industry connections
- Investor readiness

The objective is to create a structured pathway from **student innovation to enterprise development**.

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14. INVESTOR ECOSYSTEM CONNECTIVITY

NCIE may facilitate appropriate connectivity between suitable and investor-ready startups and potential:

- Angel investors
- Venture capital organisations
- Corporate investors
- Impact investors
- Investment networks
- Family offices
- Startup funds
- Other eligible investment ecosystem participants

Potential activities may include:

- Investor-readiness workshops
- Pitch preparation
- Startup showcases
- Demo days
- Investor introductions
- Pitch opportunities

Investment Disclaimer

Investor connectivity does not constitute a guarantee of investment.

Any investment shall remain subject to:

- Due diligence
- Startup quality
- Market potential
- Financial viability
- Legal compliance
- Investor interest
- Investment terms
- Independent investor decision

15. RESEARCH & KNOWLEDGE PARTNERSHIPS

NCIE may collaborate with research and knowledge organisations for:

- Research projects
- Studies
- Publications
- Knowledge resources
- Innovation reports
- Seminars
- Conferences
- Policy discussions
- Best-practice documentation
- Technology and innovation research

Research partnerships should clearly define ownership, publication rights, confidentiality and intellectual property responsibilities where applicable.

16. NGO & COMMUNITY PARTNERSHIPS

NCIE may collaborate with eligible NGOs, foundations and community organisations for:

- Youth development
- Community innovation
- Entrepreneurship
- Skills
- Digital literacy
- Social innovation
- Inclusive development
- Community-oriented programmes

Such partnerships may support outreach to underserved and emerging communities.

17. TECHNOLOGY PARTNERSHIPS

NCIE may collaborate with technology organisations for:

- Digital platforms
- Artificial Intelligence
- Cloud technologies
- Learning technologies
- Innovation tools
- Digital skills
- Technology demonstrations
- Startup technology support

Technology partnerships shall be governed by appropriate agreements covering implementation, security, data protection, licensing and responsibilities where applicable.

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18. KNOWLEDGE PARTNER FRAMEWORK

Knowledge partners may contribute:

- Subject-matter expertise
- Curriculum support
- Research
- Faculty resources
- Training
- Mentoring
- Publications
- Technical guidance

Knowledge partnerships may be established with academic institutions, research organisations, industry experts and professional bodies.

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19. COLLABORATION MODELS

NCIE may use different collaboration models depending on programme requirements.

Model 1 – MoU Partnership

A formal Memorandum of Understanding defining broad areas of cooperation.

Model 2 – Programme Agreement

A specific agreement for implementation of a defined programme.

Model 3 – Project Partnership

A project-specific collaboration with defined outputs and timelines.

Model 4 – Institutional Partnership

Long-term collaboration with an eligible college, university or organisation.

Model 5 – CSR Partnership

A CSR-supported project arrangement subject to applicable requirements.

Model 6 – Knowledge Partnership

Collaboration focused on knowledge, research, training and expertise.

Model 7 – Ecosystem Partnership

Connectivity among startups, incubators, industry, mentors and investors.

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20. MoU & AGREEMENT FRAMEWORK

Where a formal partnership is required, the agreement may specify:

- Parties
- Purpose
- Scope
- Objectives
- Activities
- Roles and responsibilities
- Deliverables
- Timeline
- Financial arrangements
- Intellectual property

- Confidentiality
- Data protection
- Branding and communications
- Monitoring
- Reporting
- Termination
- Dispute resolution
- Applicable law

No party should represent a collaboration beyond the authority and scope granted under the applicable agreement.

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21. PARTNER SELECTION & DUE DILIGENCE

Potential partners may be assessed based on:

- Legal status
- Institutional credibility
- Relevant experience
- Technical capabilities
- Financial capacity where relevant
- Programme expertise
- Compliance record
- Infrastructure
- Reputation
- Strategic relevance

NCIE may conduct appropriate documentation and due-diligence procedures before formalising significant partnerships.

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22. PARTNER ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

Each collaboration should clearly identify:

NCIE Responsibilities

Depending on the agreement:

- Programme coordination
- Institutional facilitation
- Participant mobilisation
- Training coordination
- Mentorship coordination
- Monitoring
- Documentation
- Reporting

Partner Responsibilities

Depending on the agreement:

- Resources
- Experts
- Infrastructure
- Technology
- Funding
- Mentorship
- Industry exposure
- Programme implementation
- Reporting

Specific responsibilities shall be determined by the relevant agreement or programme document.

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23. FUNDING & RESOURCE CONTRIBUTION

Partnership contributions may include:

- Financial contributions
- CSR support
- Infrastructure
- Technology
- Experts
- Mentors
- Training resources
- Scholarships
- Equipment
- Research support

- Programme management support

All financial commitments should be documented appropriately.

A partnership or MoU should not be interpreted as a financial commitment unless the relevant financial terms are expressly documented.

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24. FUNDING FACILITATION FOR INSTITUTIONS

Where appropriate, NCIE may facilitate eligible colleges and universities in developing proposals for innovation and entrepreneurship support.

Potential funding channels may include:

- Government schemes
- Ministry / Department programmes
- CSR organisations
- Industry partners
- Innovation programmes
- Incubation mechanisms
- Philanthropic organisations

Potential institutional requirements may fall within an indicative **₹5 lakh–₹25 lakh** range depending on project scope.

The amount is an **indicative programme planning range and not a guaranteed grant or funding commitment.**

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25. PROGRAMME COLLABORATION LIFECYCLE

IDENTIFICATION

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PARTNER MAPPING

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INITIAL DISCUSSION



DUE DILIGENCE



PROPOSAL DEVELOPMENT



TECHNICAL / PROGRAMME REVIEW



APPROVAL



MoU / AGREEMENT



IMPLEMENTATION



MONITORING



REPORTING



REVIEW



RENEWAL / SCALE-UP / CLOSURE



26. PARTNERSHIP GOVERNANCE

Significant collaborations should have designated:

- NCIE programme coordinator
- Partner coordinator
- Institutional nodal officer, where applicable
- Programme implementation team
- Monitoring mechanism
- Reporting mechanism

For larger programmes, a joint coordination mechanism may be established through the relevant agreement.

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27. MONITORING & PERFORMANCE REVIEW

Partnership performance may be measured through:

Input Indicators

- Resources mobilised
- Experts engaged
- Institutions onboarded
- Funding committed

Output Indicators

- Programmes conducted
- Participants reached
- Training hours
- Innovation projects
- Mentorship sessions

Outcome Indicators

- Skills developed
- Ideas validated
- Startups progressed
- Institutional capabilities strengthened
- Industry connections created

Impact Indicators

- Startup development
- Employment / enterprise outcomes where verifiable

- Innovation adoption
 - Institutional ecosystem development
 - Social and economic impact
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28. PARTNERSHIP REPORTING

Depending on the nature of the partnership, reporting may include:

- Programme reports
- Participant data
- Attendance
- Activity reports
- Financial utilisation information
- Photographic documentation
- Outcome reports
- Impact reports
- Partner performance reports

Reports should be prepared according to applicable programme and agreement requirements.

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29. BRANDING & COMMUNICATION

Use of NCIE or partner logos, names, marks and institutional identities should be subject to applicable permissions and agreement terms.

Neither party should use the other party's name or logo in a manner that falsely implies:

- Government ownership
- Government endorsement
- Accreditation
- Statutory authority
- Funding commitment
- Exclusive partnership

unless such status is formally established and documented.

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30. DATA, PRIVACY & CONFIDENTIALITY

Partnerships involving participant or institutional information should establish appropriate procedures for:

- Data collection
- Consent where applicable
- Access control
- Data security
- Confidentiality
- Data retention
- Information sharing

Sensitive or confidential information should be handled according to applicable legal and institutional requirements.

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31. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

Partnership agreements should specify ownership and permitted use of:

- Research outputs
- Innovations
- Software
- Content
- Designs
- Publications
- Trademarks
- Patents
- Other intellectual property

Ownership should not be assumed solely because an organisation participated in a collaborative programme.

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32. CONFLICT OF INTEREST

NCIE and participating partners should identify and appropriately manage potential conflicts of interest.

Where a conflict exists, the concerned person or organisation may be

required to disclose the conflict and follow applicable procedures.

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33. PARTNERSHIP ETHICS

NCIE collaborations should promote:

- Integrity
- Transparency
- Non-discrimination
- Professional conduct
- Responsible innovation
- Fair participation
- Accountability
- Compliance

Partners should not make misleading claims regarding programme outcomes, funding, Government association or investment opportunities.

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34. PARTNERSHIP RISK MANAGEMENT

Potential risks may include:

- Regulatory risk
- Financial risk
- Reputational risk
- Operational risk
- Data risk
- Technology risk
- Partnership-performance risk
- Conflict-of-interest risk

Appropriate mitigation measures should be incorporated into significant partnership arrangements.

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35. PARTNERSHIP DATABASE

NCIE may maintain a structured partnership database containing, as appropriate:

- Partner name
- Organisation type
- Contact information
- Partnership category
- Agreement details
- Programme area
- Start date
- Review date
- Status
- Activities
- Outcomes
- Documentation

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36. PARTNERSHIP RECOGNITION

Where appropriate, NCIE may recognise participating organisations as:

- Institutional Partners
- Academic Partners
- Knowledge Partners
- Industry Partners
- CSR Partners
- Innovation Partners
- Ecosystem Partners
- Programme Partners

Such recognition should accurately reflect the nature and scope of the actual collaboration.

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37. STRATEGIC ECOSYSTEM MODEL

NCIE's collaboration ecosystem may be represented as:

GOVERNMENT & PUBLIC INSTITUTIONS



NCIE



COLLEGES & UNIVERSITIES



INDUSTRY



CSR ORGANISATIONS



INCUBATORS & ACCELERATORS



MENTORS & KNOWLEDGE PARTNERS



STARTUPS & INNOVATORS



INVESTOR ECOSYSTEM



COMMUNITY & DEVELOPMENT ORGANISATIONS

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38. PARTNERSHIP OUTCOME FRAMEWORK

The overall collaboration model follows:

CONNECT

Build institutional relationships.



COLLABORATE

Develop programmes and projects.



CAPACITATE

Build skills and institutional capabilities.



INNOVATE

Develop ideas and solutions.



INCUBATE

Support suitable startup development.



CONNECT TO ECOSYSTEM

Facilitate industry, funding and investor connectivity.



CREATE IMPACT

Measure educational, entrepreneurial, social and economic outcomes.



39. REVIEW & RENEWAL

Partnerships may be periodically reviewed based on:

- Performance
- Programme outcomes
- Partner contribution
- Beneficiary feedback
- Compliance
- Strategic relevance
- Sustainability

Based on the review, partnerships may be:

- Continued
- Renewed
- Expanded
- Modified
- Suspended
- Concluded



40. FRAMEWORK STATEMENT

The NCIE Collaboration & Partnership Framework seeks to establish a transparent, structured and outcome-oriented ecosystem through which Government and public-sector stakeholders, academic institutions, industry, CSR organisations, incubators, accelerators, investors, NGOs and knowledge partners can contribute to innovation, entrepreneurship, technology, skill development and institutional strengthening.

NCIE may facilitate appropriate programme, institutional, funding and ecosystem linkages within the scope of its organisational mandate. All Government collaboration, funding, CSR support, investment and institutional assistance shall remain subject to applicable eligibility requirements, formal approvals, agreements, due diligence, availability of resources and the independent decisions of the respective Government authority, funding organisation, corporate partner, institution or investor.

NCIE COLLABORATION MODEL

PARTNER

- CONNECT
- COLLABORATE
- IMPLEMENT
- MONITOR
- MEASURE
- SCALE
- IMPACT

**Together for Innovation. Entrepreneurship. Skills.
Institutions. Startups. Impact.**